

COMPUTER ORGANIZATION AND
ASSEMBLY LANGUAGE
LAB ASSIGNMENT NO. 01



NAME : ALEENA AKHTAR

SAP ID : 69273

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Riphaah International University
Gulberg Green Campus

‘QUESTION’

Difference between compiler, interpreter and assembler.

‘ANSWER’

Computers execute programs only in machine language. Therefore, programs written in high-level or assembly languages must be translated into machine code using language processors such as **compiler**, **interpreter**, and **assembler**. These translators differ in their method of translation and execution.

COMPILER

A **compiler** translates the **entire high-level language program** into machine code **before execution** and generates an executable file. Errors are reported after compilation, and the compiled program runs faster since translation occurs only once. Compilers are used for large and performance-oriented applications (e.g., C, C++).

INTERPRETER

An **interpreter** translates and executes a **program line by line** at runtime. It does not create a separate executable file. Errors are detected immediately, but program execution is slower due to repeated translation. Interpreters are commonly used for scripting and debugging (e.g., Python, JavaScript).

ASSEMBLER

An **assembler** converts **assembly language** into machine language, usually using a one-to-one instruction mapping. Assembly language is machine-dependent, and the resulting code is highly efficient. Assemblers are mainly used in system programming and embedded systems.

COMPARISON TABLE

Features	Assembler	Interpreter	Compiler
Source Language	Assembly language	High-level language	High-level language
Translation Method	Instruction by instruction	Line by line	Entire program at once
Output	Machine code	No separate output file	Executable machine code
Execution Speed	Very fast	Slow	Fast
Error Detection	After assembly	One error at a time	After compilation
Reusability	Executable reused	Must re-interpret every run	Executable reused
Dependency	Machine-dependent	Platform-independent	Mostly platform-independent
Examples	MASM, NASM	Python, JavaScript	C, C++, Java

Thank You!!!!